

1. Summary of Graduate Project in Abstract Format Guidelines

Purpose and Scope

- The abstract is a concise, stand-alone summary of your graduate project. It must clearly state the problem, the approach or methodology, key findings, and conclusions.
- It is used when the project is submitted “in abstract form,” particularly for creative or applied research projects.

Formatting Requirements

- **Typeface & Font Size:** Use Times New Roman in either 10- or 12-point size consistently.
- **Margins & Spacing:** One-inch margins on all sides with double spacing for the main text (exceptions may be made for elements like captions or long quotations).
- **Pagination:** Preliminary pages (which include the abstract) are numbered in lowercase Roman numerals (with the title page unnumbered).
- **Headings:** The abstract must be clearly labeled with “Abstract,” with formatting matching the title page guidelines.

Content and Structure

- **Title Page:** This must precede the abstract. It includes the project title (with strict capitalization rules), the candidate’s official name, the degree name, and the date of conferral.
- **Abstract Text:**
 - Should be clear, concise, and not exceed preset limits (typically around 350 words or 2,450 characters).
 - Must briefly describe the problem or objective, methodology/approach, key findings or outcomes, and a conclusion or recommendation.
- **Language:** The abstract must be written entirely in English.
- **Submission:** The abstract is submitted electronically through the ETD system along with other preliminary pages.

Additional Considerations

- For collaborative projects, only the abstract and preliminary pages must be uniformly prepared, while other sections may vary.
- Uniformity in style (spacing, font, margins, headings) throughout the abstract is essential.

For full details, please see the official guidelines available here:

<https://live-csu-northridge.pantheonsite.io/sites/default/files/2024-11/Project-Guidelines-Abstract.pdf>

2. Example Abstract – Analytics Using World Data Bank Data

Title Page Information (to be included on a separate title page):

CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY, NORTHRIDGE

Analytics of Global Economic Trends Using World Data Bank Data

A Graduate Project submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements

For the degree of Master of Science in Data Analytics

By

Jordan Smith

May 2025

(Official end of the semester)

Abstract

This study employs advanced data analytics techniques to explore global economic trends using extensive datasets from the World Data Bank. Three primary objectives guide the research: to assess the relationship between economic growth and social development indicators, to analyze the influence of international trade dynamics on regional economies, and to evaluate the role of environmental sustainability in enhancing economic competitiveness. To address these objectives, the investigation is structured around twelve research questions that examine various dimensions of economic performance. These questions include: how GDP growth correlates with education attainment levels; the impact of income inequality on social spending; the influence of trade balances on employment rates; the role of export diversification in building economic resilience; the effects of foreign direct investment on regional growth trajectories; the contribution of technological adoption to economic performance; the association between environmental sustainability indices and economic competitiveness; the effect of renewable energy adoption on national GDP growth; the impact of government environmental policies on international trade; the correlation between labor force participation and overall economic output; the relationship between healthcare expenditure and economic stability; and the significance of infrastructure investment in fostering economic development. Utilizing econometric models and comprehensive data visualizations, the analysis spans over 150 countries spanning the past two decades, revealing significant interdependencies among economic, social, and environmental factors. The findings provide policymakers with actionable insights to drive sustainable and inclusive growth.